AI and Operational Effectiveness

NZ ARMY
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THE QUESTION How can Army use AI to increase operational effectiveness?

Use AI where it removes a real limit on what Army can do, and where that makes Army more capable.

A small army that cannot fight when the tools are denied has not gained effectiveness. It has moved its dependence.

THE MODEL

How to decide where to use AI

Output	Task	Constraint	AI	Human Role	Assurance	Competence	Effect
What must we achieve?	What limits it?	Why?	How would AI help?	What stays human?	What control is needed?	Who must be able to do what?	Did it improve the output?

If you cannot say what is limiting the task, and how AI would help, stop.

HOW MUCH HUMAN CONTROL

The more it matters if AI gets it wrong, the more human control and checking is required

How bad if it is wrong? · Can we undo it? · Can a person check it?

WHERE AI HELPS MOST

Planning and staff work
Faster plans, more options properly considered
AUGMENT
Commander decides and accepts risk

Intelligence and readiness
See more, sooner, from more sources
AUGMENT / ENABLE
People judge what it means

Generating trained people
Train more people, more ways, to one standard
AUGMENT / ENABLE
Instructors coach and assure the standard

Learning and adaptation
Turn experience into changed training faster
ENABLE
Commanders decide what changes

Administrative load
Less time on paperwork
AUTOMATE
You own what you sign

THE IMPLICATIONS

Army People

Everyone understands it

Many employ it

Leaders govern it

A few specialise in it

The Principles

1 **Effect first**
Measure Army output, not AI use.

2 **Task before tool**
Start with the constraint, not the technology.

3 **The commander owns it**
AI advises. The commander decides and signs.

4 **Assurance by consequence**
More human control where getting it wrong matters more.

5 **Competence before dependence**
Practise the skill. Never depend on AI for what Army must do without it.

Priority Actions

1 **Own it**
Put someone in charge. Say what needs approval and what does not.

2 **Prove effect in three places**
Planning, training design, readiness data. Stop what does not work.

3 **Train it through the approach**
Train on real tasks. Test core skills without the tool. Instructors first.

4 **Improve the data**
Readiness and training data are probably the limit. Fix that first.

5 **Compress the lessons cycle**
Get lessons into training faster than the threat changes.